
THE FREE PLAYBOOK

LOOK STUPIDLY GOOD ON SOCIAL MEDIA

The proven 8-step system to make your business look
stupidly good online, without ever hiring a videographer

BY PULSE SOCIAL MEDIA

BEFORE WE START

WELCOME TO THE PLAYBOOK

Hi, I'm Will, and I'm the founder of Pulse Social Media. You're probably here because posting good, consistent content for your business is a constant struggle. Well, I'm here to help. I shoot every piece of content my clients post myself, so everything in here is straight from what I actually do every day, not theory pulled off the internet. Over the next few steps I'm going to hand you the exact, proven strategies I use to get real results for my clients, time and time again.

Here's what you'll get out of this playbook:

- **Step 1:** Win customers who are ready to buy
- **Step 2:** Get recognised in a single scroll
- **Step 3:** Never wonder what to post again
- **Step 4:** Stop the scroll in the first 3 seconds
- **Step 5:** Shoot like a pro on just a phone
- **Step 6:** Create weeks of content in one afternoon
- **Step 7:** Grow every week without posting every day
- **Step 8:** Turn views into paying customers
- **Bonus:** Turn happy customers into your best salespeople

STEP 1 · DREAM CUSTOMER

WIN CUSTOMERS WHO ARE READY TO BUY, WITHOUT WASTING POSTS ON THE WRONG PEOPLE

Before anything else, you need to know exactly who you're selling to and who you're making content for. For example, content that's fast-paced and exciting might not connect very well with someone looking to buy flowers for a funeral.

So knowing who you're creating for, and who you're selling to, really matters. Make sure you understand things like:

- What does their daily routine look like? Should you be posting when they're having their morning coffee, or when they're winding down at night?
- What platforms do your dream customers actually use? (e.g. Facebook, Instagram, YouTube)
- Is your customer looking to be entertained, helped, or informed?
- What kind of language do they use? Are they formal, or more chilled and laid-back?

Here's how to actually pin this down. Don't try to talk to "everyone", picture one real person. Give them a name, an age, a job, a daily routine, and the problem they're lying awake worrying about. The more specific you get, the easier every future post becomes, because you're no longer writing for a faceless crowd, you're writing for Sarah, the busy café owner who checks Instagram on her break and just wants more bums on seats.

And you don't have to guess. The answers are sitting right in front of you if you go looking:

- **Talk to your best customers.** The ones you love working with, ask why they chose you and what nearly stopped them.
- **Read your comments and DMs.** The exact words people use are the exact words you should be putting in your captions.
- **Check who's already following you.** Most platforms show you the age, location and active hours of your audience for free in the analytics tab.
- **Spy on competitors.** Look at who's commenting on the accounts you admire, that's your customer too.

Once you know exactly who you're talking to, everything else gets easier. You'll know what to post, when to post it, and how to say it, because you're not shouting into the void, you're having a conversation with one person who's ready to buy.

EXAMPLE

A café owner stopped posting generic 'we're open!' updates and started talking straight to busy locals craving a quick, quality coffee. Same café, far more foot traffic.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Write a short profile of your dream customer: name, age, job, and the one problem keeping them up at night.

STEP 2 · BRAND VOICE

GET RECOGNISED IN A SINGLE SCROLL, WITHOUT A BIG BRANDING BUDGET

If you want people on social media to recognise your content the second it shows up in their feed, you need a specific brand voice and style. The way you write needs to be consistent across everything you put out, so that when someone sees your content they instantly know it's you. That recognition is what builds trust, and trust is what keeps your brand consistent and memorable across every single post.

So what actually is a brand voice? Think of it as the personality of your business put into words. If your brand were a person, how would they talk? Are they warm and funny, or sharp and to the point? Do they swear a little, or keep it polished? Would they say “let's smash this” or “let us help you achieve your goals”? There's no right answer, there's only what's right for you and the customer you're trying to reach. The mistake most businesses make is not picking one at all, so their content feels like it was written by five different people.

A simple way to nail yours down is to pick three or four words that describe how you want to come across, say “friendly, confident, no-nonsense, a bit cheeky”, and then write every caption as if those words are sitting on your shoulder. It also helps to jot down a few things your brand would *never* say. Knowing what's off-limits keeps you in your lane just as much as knowing what's on-brand.

A few things to lock in so your voice stays consistent:

- **Tone:** formal or casual? Playful or serious? Pick a lane and stay in it.
- **Vocabulary:** the words and phrases you use again and again, and the ones you avoid.
- **Point of view:** are you speaking as “I”, or as “we”? Keep it the same everywhere.
- **The little things:** emojis or no emojis, short punchy lines or longer ones, how you sign off, small choices that add up to a recognisable style.

And remember, your voice isn't just the words, it's the look too. The colours, the fonts, the style of your photos and videos all need to sing from the same songbook. When your writing and your visuals match, your content becomes instantly recognisable, even before someone sees your name. That's the goal: someone scrolls past, doesn't even read the handle, and just knows it's you.

EXAMPLE

Gymshark's captions always sound the same: punchy, motivational, a little cheeky. You know it's them before you even see the logo.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Write down 4 words that sum up your brand's personality, then rewrite your last caption so it sounds like them.

STEP 3 · WHAT TO POST

NEVER WONDER WHAT TO POST AGAIN

The number one thing that stops people posting? Not knowing what to post. The simplest way to never run dry is to work from three content buckets and rotate through them: educate, entertain, and sell.

- **Educate:** teach your customer something useful. Tips, how-tos, myth-busting, answers to the questions you get asked all the time.
- **Entertain:** show some personality. Behind the scenes, a laugh, a story. This is what makes people actually like you.
- **Sell:** tell people what you offer and how to buy it. Don't be shy, nobody can buy what they don't know exists.

The mistake most businesses make is only ever posting 'sell' content, then wondering why no one engages. Aim for roughly 80% educate and entertain, 20% sell. If every post asks for the sale, you're a billboard. Give value first and you earn the right to sell.

EXAMPLE

A plumber posts a quick 'how to stop a tap dripping' video (educate), a blooper from a flooded job (entertain), then 'book your winter pipe check' (sell). Same week, three angles.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Write down 3 post ideas: one that educates, one that entertains, one that sells. That's your next three posts sorted.

STEP 4 · HOOKS

STOP THE SCROLL IN THE FIRST 3 SECONDS

You can make the best video in the world, but if the first 3 seconds are boring, nobody sees the rest. On social media you're not competing with other businesses, you're competing with everyone's thumb. The hook, your first line or first shot, decides whether they stop or scroll on. Get it right and everything else has a chance to work.

- **Lead with the payoff:** 'Here's how to get X without Y', not a slow wind-up.
- **Call them out:** 'If you own a café, watch this.' People stop for things clearly about them.
- **Spark curiosity:** 'Most people get this completely wrong...'
- **Open on your best shot:** never start with a slow pan or 'Hey guys, welcome back.'
- **Put a bold text hook on screen** in the first second so it lands even on mute.

Spend as much time on your first line as you do on the rest of the caption combined. It really is that important.

EXAMPLE

'3 mistakes killing your coffee sales' stops a café owner dead. 'Welcome to our page!' gets scrolled past in half a second.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Take your last post and rewrite the opening line three different ways, each one a stronger hook. Use the best.

STEP 5 · PHONE CONTENT

SHOOT CONTENT LIKE A PRO, EVEN IF ALL YOU OWN IS A PHONE

Making good-looking content on your phone is a lot easier than it seems, especially with how good modern phones and the right tools are these days.

First up, whatever you're shooting on, iPhone, Pixel, Samsung, whatever you've got, always shoot on the back camera. If you can, shoot at 60 frames per second so you get a smoother look and can slow it down later if you need to. If you want to shoot in 4K, go for it, but honestly, in my opinion it doesn't make much of a difference.

Try to avoid zooming in at all. On most phones, the more you zoom, the grainier it looks, so stick to 1x or 0.5x where you can. And if you're doing talking-head or voiceover videos, consider grabbing a microphone and a tripod. If you're shooting a lot of cinematic or

showcase content, a cheap gimbal is well worth picking up too.

But honestly, the camera settings are the easy part. What actually separates good-looking content from amateur stuff comes down to three things: light, sound and a steady shot.

Nail those and you're 90% of the way there.

- **Light:** keep the light behind the camera so it falls on you, never behind you. A window during the day is the best free studio you'll ever find. If you're filming yourself, face the window so the light hits you, not the back of your head.
- **Sound:** bad audio kills a video faster than bad video. Film somewhere quiet, get close to your phone, and grab a cheap clip-on mic if you talk to camera a lot, it's the best \$30 you'll spend.
- **Stability:** a shaky shot looks amateur instantly. Prop your phone against something, use a tripod, or just tuck your elbows into your body to steady your hands.
- **Framing:** leave a little space above your head, put yourself slightly off-centre, and clean up the background, a tidy, simple backdrop always looks more professional.
- **Depth:** don't shoot flat against a wall. Put space between your subject and the background so the shot feels three-dimensional. A bit of foreground, or a background that stretches off into the distance, makes your content look instantly more cinematic. The same trick works on a product, angle it so the shelf or counter trails off behind it instead of shooting it dead flat.
- **Showcase shots:** filming your shop or a product instead of yourself? Move slowly and smoothly, mix a wide shot of the space with tight close-ups of the details, and capture it from a few angles. Let the camera glide rather than jerk around and you'll have plenty of footage to cut together.
- **Shoot vertical:** for Reels, TikTok and Stories, film in portrait (9:16) so it fills the whole screen. Hold the phone upright, not sideways.

Last tip: shoot a few seconds of extra footage at the start and end of every clip. It gives you room to trim and makes editing so much easier. Get these basics right and your phone footage will look better than businesses spending thousands on a videographer.

Let AI take the grunt work. Before you film, ask an AI tool to fire out a few hook ideas and a simple shot list so you're not winging it on the day. After filming, lean on AI editing tools like CapCut or Descript to add auto-captions and clean up your audio in seconds. You still bring the real, authentic content, AI just speeds up everything around it.

And if being in front of (or behind) the camera just isn't your thing? This is exactly the kind of content I shoot for my clients, day in, day out, so they never have to.

EXAMPLE

Film one clip facing a window, then one with the window behind you. The first looks bright and pro; the second looks like a hostage video.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Grab your phone, set the back camera to 60fps, stand facing a window, and film a real 20-second clip, either talking to the camera about what you do, or walking through your shop showing off a product.

STEP 6 · YOUR TIME

CREATE WEEKS OF CONTENT IN A SINGLE AFTERNOON, EVEN IF YOU'RE FLAT OUT

Let's be honest, the number one reason most business owners stop posting isn't that they run out of ideas, it's that they run out of time. You're already wearing ten hats running your business, and "make content" keeps sliding to the bottom of the list. The trick isn't finding more hours in the day, it's being smarter with the ones you've got.

The biggest game-changer here is batching. Instead of trying to film, edit and post something every single day, set aside one block of time, even just a couple of hours a week, and shoot a whole batch of content in one go. You're already dressed, the lighting's good and you're in the zone, so you may as well knock out five or six videos while you're at it. One afternoon of filming can easily give you a few weeks of content.

The same goes for the boring bits. Write a batch of captions in one sitting. Edit a few videos back to back. Then use a scheduling tool to line everything up in advance and let it post automatically while you get on with actually running your business. Do the work once and let it pay you back for weeks.

And don't fall into the trap of thinking every post needs to be a cinematic masterpiece. A quick, honest video shot on your phone in two minutes will almost always beat the "perfect" one that never gets posted. Done beats perfect, every single time.

EXAMPLE

One business owner blocks a two-hour Sunday shoot, walks away with a fortnight of content, then forgets about posting all week while it goes out on autopilot.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Block one 2-hour 'content session' in your calendar this week and commit to filming 5 clips back to back.

STEP 7 · CONSISTENCY

GROW YOUR AUDIENCE EVERY WEEK, WITHOUT POSTING EVERY DAY

If there's one thing that separates the accounts that grow from the ones that don't, it's consistency. Not luck, not a single viral video, just showing up, over and over again. The platforms reward accounts that post regularly, and so do people. When someone sees your content week after week, you start to feel familiar, and familiar builds trust.

Consistency does two things. First, it gives the algorithm more chances to put you in front of the right people, every post is another shot on goal. Second, it trains your audience to expect you. The businesses that win on social media are the ones people remember, and you don't get remembered by posting once a month.

But posting is only half of it. The other half is engagement. Social media is a two-way street, not a billboard. When people comment, reply to them. When someone else in your space posts something good, get in the conversation. The more you genuinely engage, the more the platform sees you as an active, valuable account, and the more real relationships you build with the people who might one day buy from you.

You don't need to be everywhere all at once. Pick a realistic schedule you can actually stick to, even three solid posts a week, every week, will beat ten posts one week and nothing for a month. Consistency compounds. Keep showing up, and the results stack up over time.

Never run out of ideas. The hardest part of staying consistent is knowing what to post. This is where AI shines: feed it your niche and your dream customer and ask for 30 content ideas, a month of hooks, or a full week's posting plan. You'll never stare at a blank page again, and that kills the number one excuse for going quiet.

EXAMPLE

An account that posts 3 times a week for 3 months will almost always beat one that posted daily for a fortnight, then vanished.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Pick the 3 days you'll post each week, add them to your calendar as recurring events, and schedule this week's 3 posts today.

STEP 8 · TURN VIEWS INTO CUSTOMERS

TURN VIEWS INTO PAYING CUSTOMERS

Views feel great, but they don't pay the bills. This is the step almost everyone skips, they chase likes and forget the whole point: getting people to buy. Every piece of content should gently point somewhere.

- **Always have a call to action.** Tell people exactly what to do next: 'DM us PRICE', 'link in bio', 'book a call', 'comment below'.
- **Make it stupidly easy to buy.** A clear link in your bio, a booking page, a simple way to enquire. Don't make them hunt for it.
- **Use your DMs.** A comment or message is a warm lead, start a real conversation, don't leave them on read.
- **Capture them off the platform.** Get people onto an email list or booking page. You don't own your followers, but you own your list.
- **Talk about your offer regularly.** People need to hear it more than once before they act.

The money truth: attention is only worth something if you do something with it. A small, engaged audience that buys beats a huge one that doesn't.

This is the bit most businesses never quite nail on their own, and it's a big part of what I help my clients with: turning all that attention into actual booked work.

EXAMPLE

A salon posts a great haircut transformation, then adds 'DM us CHAIR to book this week.' Comments turn into bookings instead of just likes.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Add one clear call to action to your next post, and make sure the link or booking page it points to actually works.

BONUS · TRUST & SOCIAL PROOF

TURN HAPPY CUSTOMERS INTO YOUR BEST SALESPEOPLE

Great content gets you seen. Trust gets you paid. People buy from businesses they trust, and social media is where that trust is won or lost. The good news? You can build it on purpose:

- **Show your work, don't just talk about it.** Post before-and-afters, finished jobs and the process. Proof beats promises every time.
- **Collect proof on autopilot.** Ask every happy customer for a quick review or a few words on camera. Screenshot the kind DMs and save them all.
- **Put real customers front and centre.** A genuine testimonial with a name and a face is worth more than anything you could say about yourself.
- **Show the human behind the business.** Introduce yourself and your team. People trust people, not faceless logos.
- **Reply to everything.** Every comment you answer tells the world there's a real, responsive person here who cares.
- **Remove the risk.** Guarantees, no lock-in, a free first chat, anything that makes saying "yes" feel completely safe.

Build proof into your routine: every finished job is a before/after, every happy customer is a potential testimonial. Capture it as you go and you'll never be short of trust-building content.

EXAMPLE

A tradie started posting a before-and-after photo of every job. Within months he was booked out, the photos did the selling for him.

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

Next time you finish a job or make a customer happy, capture it (a photo, a screenshot, or a quick quote) and save it to a 'proof' folder on your phone.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

DO THESE 9 THINGS TODAY

Reading is easy. Doing is what grows your business. Knock these out today and you'll be ahead of 90% of businesses on social media.

- **Dream customer:** write a short profile of one ideal customer, name, age, job, and their biggest worry.
- **Brand voice:** write down 4 words that sum up your brand, then rewrite your last caption to match.
- **What to post:** write 3 post ideas, one that educates, one that entertains, one that sells.
- **Hooks:** rewrite your last post's opening line three ways and pick the strongest.
- **Phone content:** film one real 20-second clip on your back camera at 60fps, facing a window, talking to camera or showing a product.
- **Your time:** block a 2-hour 'content session' in your calendar this week.
- **Consistency:** pick your 3 posting days, set them as recurring calendar events, and schedule this week's posts.
- **Turn views into customers:** add a clear call to action to your next post and check the link works.
- **Trust:** start a 'proof' folder and drop in your first photo, screenshot or customer quote.

The only rule: don't try to do all nine perfectly. Just start. Done today beats perfect next month, every single time.

WHERE TO GO FROM HERE

So there you have it, the eight steps I use to help my clients show up consistently, look professional and actually connect with the people they're trying to reach. From nailing your brand voice to turning views into paying customers, get these working together and you'll be miles ahead of most businesses on social media.

But here's the catch. Doing all eight, every single week, forever, while you're already flat out running everything else? That's the hard part. Most business owners start strong and quietly fade by week three, not because they're lazy, but because they've got an actual business to run.

So if you'd rather spend your energy running your business while someone handles the content side properly, the strategy, the shooting, the posting, all of it, that's exactly what I do.

Book a free, no-pressure chat and we'll talk through where your social media's at and how we can take it to the next level.

[Insert your booking link here]